



◁ Tupolev Tu-95 "Bear" 1955

Origin USSR

Engine 4 x 14,800 lb (6,704 kg)

thrust Kuznetsov NK-12M turboprop

Top speed 562 mph (905 km/h)

Combining unusually sweptback wings and contra-rotating propellers, the Tu-95 has an exceptional range (laden) of 9,320 miles (15,000 km) without refueling. It is likely to be in service until 2040.



△ Avro 698 Vulcan 1956

Origin UK

Engine 4 x 17,000 lb (7,701 kg) thrust Bristol Siddeley Olympus Mk202 turbojet

Top speed 708 mph (1,139 km/h)

Powered by the world's first two-spool axial flow turbojets, Avro's radical delta-wing Vulcan spearheaded Britain's nuclear deterrent. It had a high payload and was difficult to detect with radar.



△ Saab J35E Draken 1955

Origin Sweden

Engine 12,787-17,637 lb (5,793-7,990 kg) thrust Volvo Flygmotor RM 6C afterburning turbojet

Top speed 1,340 mph (2,150 km/h)

An effective supersonic Cold War fighter, the Draken's unusual double-delta wing gave good speed and agility. It was designed to take off from public roads and be rearmed in 10 minutes; 644 were built.



△ Fouga CM-17OR Magister 1956

Origin France

Engine 2 x 880 lb (399 kg) thrust Turbomeca Marboré IIA turbojet

Top speed 444 mph (715 km/h)

One of the first turbojet-powered two-seat trainers, the distinctive V-tail Magister was used by air forces worldwide and 929 were built. From 1960 it was fitted with the more powerful Marboré engine.



△ Douglas A-4 Skyhawk 1956

Origin USA

Engine 8,200 lb (3,715 kg) thrust Wright J65 turbojet

Top speed 673 mph (1,077 km/h)

This was a front-line jet that achieved performance through reduced size and weight rather than sheer engine power. Ed Heinemann's design for the US Navy had such a small delta wing it had no need to fold for carrier use.



◁ Sukhoi Su-7B 1959

Origin USSR

Engine 14,980-22,150 lb (6,786-10,034 kg) thrust Lyulka AL-7F afterburning turbojet

Top speed 1,335 mph (2,148 km/h)

First flown in 1955 as a fighter, with all-moving tailplane and movable-cone air intake, the Su-7 was refined for ground attack in 1959 as the Su-7B; 1,847 aircraft were built.